



» FROM THE  
WORLD OF FOOTBALL

# NET, SET, GO

Several top teams prevailed in thrilling **goal fests** ahead of the international break, while the derbies lived up to the hype.

**Joan Mathew Jacob**

[joan.mathew@thehindu.co.in](mailto:joan.mathew@thehindu.co.in)

**E**nzo Maresca's Manchester City has emerged as an early frontrunner in the Premier League, courtesy of vastly contrasting wins against Manchester United and Sunderland.

First up, the derby, which was perhaps the biggest game of the fortnight, did not disappoint. It started with Phil Foden shown marching orders for kicking out at Bruno Fernandes, making him the first City player since Bernardo Corradi in 2006 to receive a red card in this fixture.

However, despite being a man down, City came away with three points thanks to a highly controversial goal from Erling Haaland. Initially ruled out for offside, the goal was reviewed and awarded, with VAR choosing to ignore Enzo Fernández's impact